

The Back-End Automation Engine

Extending the quote system that is already running: from inbound email all the way to the truck.

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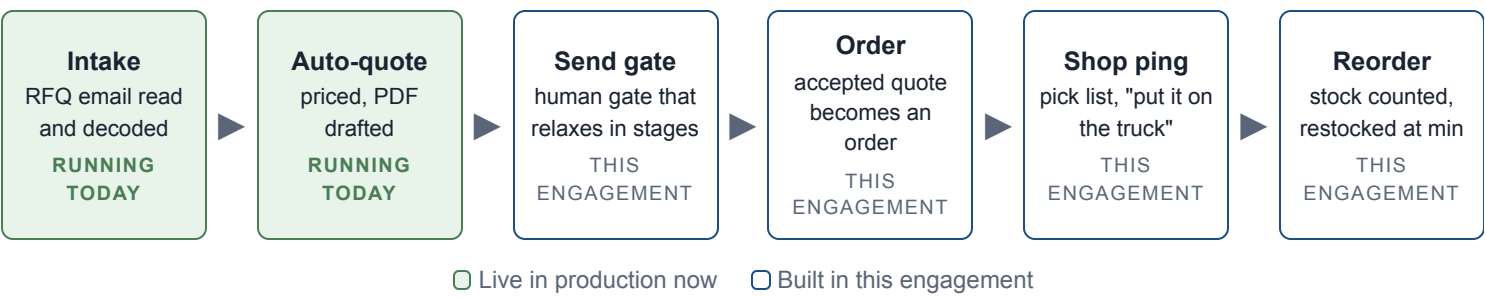
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WHAT IS ALREADY RUNNING

Your quote system is live in production today. It watches the RFQ inbox, reads each email and its attachments, pulls out the customer, the products, the sizes, and the quantities, prices the standard items from your formulas and catalog, and writes a finished quote with a PDF into Outlook Drafts. A person reviews the draft and clicks send. Anything the system cannot price cleanly is marked "needs pricing" and waits for a human. That part is done and working.

This engagement extends that same pipeline. It is not a new system. Each piece below picks up where the last one stops, until a quote that a customer accepts turns into an order, a pick list, a ping to the shop, and a stock count that reorders on its own.

THE WHOLE PATH



THE FOUNDATION WORK FIRST

Before anything in this system is allowed to act on its own, the plumbing underneath it gets hardened. Today the engine drafts quotes and a person sends them, so a rare hiccup costs nothing: a duplicate draft sits in Outlook and gets deleted. Once the engine can send a quote, create an order, or reorder stock by itself, the same hiccup would reach a customer or a supplier. So the engagement starts with that foundation:

- The background worker restarts cleanly during deploys instead of being cut off mid-job.

- Every inbound email is tracked in a ledger, so if the system ever re-reads a message it recognizes it and does nothing, instead of making a second quote.
- The database is checked and, if needed, upgraded so that orders, shop updates, and stock counts can all write at the same time without stepping on each other.

None of this changes what you see day to day. It is the reason the automatic stages can be trusted to fire.

THE NEW STAGES, ONE AT A TIME

1. The send gate: from "a person clicks send" to "it sends the safe ones itself"

Goes in: the finished quote drafts the system already produces
Comes out: quotes sent to customers, some by a person, over time most by the engine

Today every quote is sent by a person. This stage replaces that fixed rule with a gate that relaxes in steps. Each quote gets a confidence score built from specific checks: did every line decode cleanly, is every line priced, is this a known customer with a confirmed address, and is the price in line with what we have quoted them before.

The gate opens in stages. First the engine only recommends: it shows you the score and the reasons, and a person still clicks send. Then quotes that pass every check, to known customers, send themselves, and everything else waits for a person. Over time the automatic slice widens until only the exceptions wait: new customers, unusual prices, big dollar amounts.

To be plain about it: this is a gate that relaxes as the engine earns trust, not a switch that flips. A quote with any unpriced line never sends itself. Every automatic send is logged with the checks it passed. And there is a kill switch that puts every quote back in human hands instantly.

2. Orders: an accepted quote becomes a real order

Goes in: a sent quote and the customer's "yes"
Comes out: an order record, with a status you can watch from accepted to shipped

Today the system's world ends when a quote is sent. Nothing in it knows whether the customer said yes. This stage adds the order itself: a record created from the exact quote the customer saw, line for line, that then moves through accepted, ordered, and fulfilled.

One decision here is yours to make: how the system learns that a customer said yes. It can be an explicit "accepted" click by whoever takes the call, it can be triggered by a PO arriving, or the engine can read reply emails. My recommendation is to start with the explicit click, because it can never misread a

"thanks, we'll think about it" as a yes, and add reply-reading later behind the same kind of confidence gate as the send stage. We will settle that together before this stage is built.

3. Fulfillment: the pick list and the shop ping

Goes in: a confirmed order
Comes out: a pick list for the shop and a notification: put this on the truck

When an order is confirmed, the engine writes the pick list itself: exactly what was quoted, in whole pieces and pallets the way the yard actually stocks and ships, and tells the shop. This is the stage that replaces the hand-typed sales order. The pick list comes from the same frozen copy of the quote the customer accepted, so what the shop pulls is what the customer was quoted, with no re-typing in between.

The ping starts in the form the shop already uses: a printed sheet for the driver, a call or message to the floor. Structured screens in the shop can come later. Each order tracks its progress: queued, picked, loaded, shipped.

4. Inventory: stock counts, minimums, and automatic reorder

Goes in: every fulfillment (stock goes down), every receipt (stock goes up)
Comes out: a live on-hand count per item, and a reorder to the shop when an item hits its minimum

The last stage gives every stocked item a live count. When fulfillment ships something, the count goes down. Each item carries a minimum and a maximum you set. When the count crosses the minimum, the engine sends a reorder through the same shop channel the fulfillment stage uses, and every movement lands in a ledger so you can see why any count is what it is.

One factual question comes first, and it is for you: where do today's stock numbers live, if anywhere, and what should seed the starting counts and the min/max levels. The build of this stage starts from that answer.

ORDER OF WORK

CHECKPOINT	WHAT IS WORKING WHEN IT LANDS
1 — Foundation	Discovery and hardening: clean restarts, the message ledger, the database decision. The base the automatic stages sit on.

CHECKPOINT	WHAT IS WORKING WHEN IT LANDS
2 — Send gate	The confidence score and the dashboard, starting in recommend-only mode, then automatic sending for the safe slice.
3 — Orders	The order record and the acceptance step, using whichever "customer said yes" signal we settle on.
4 — Fulfillment	Pick lists generated from accepted orders and the shop notified, paper and phone first.
5 — Inventory	Stock counts live, minimums set, and the first automatic reorder firing when a count crosses its line.

Each checkpoint is something you can see working before the next one starts. The order is fixed by dependency, not preference: nothing sends itself before the foundation is hardened, nothing fulfills before there is an order, and nothing reorders before fulfillment is counting stock down.

PRICE AND TERMS

This is one engagement at one price: **\$12,000, fixed**. It covers everything described above, delivered in the five checkpoints in the order listed. **\$3,000** (25%) is due to start; the remaining **\$9,000** is due net-45 from completion. No per-stage invoices, no meter.

ACCEPTANCE

This page is the agreement. Signing it covers the work described above, delivered in five checkpoints for **\$12,000 fixed**, with **\$3,000** down and the balance net-45. It extends the quote system you already own; like that system, the code and the data are yours, running on the private server we manage for you. Sign and send back any copy, paper or PDF both fine.

_____ Chip Edwards, Allan Edwards Inc.	_____ Date
_____ Devin Venable, 918 Software	_____ Date

